Nicolas Rakotoary

is a creative person.

Art direction / Motion design / Graphic design / Illustration

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nicolas@nicorako.com

Hello

Your friendly *designer* & *motion graphics* artist.

My name is Nicolas Rakotoary, but you can call me **Nico Rako**. I'm a graduate of **Gobelins, Paris**, class of 2003 — that's **23 years** of honing my craft in graphic design and motion.

I lived in Paris for a while, then found my heart's delight in the **Pays Basque**, Southwest of France. Open to **freelance projects worldwide**, in French or English, and happy to discuss permanent positions too.

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Approach

Every project starts with an idea, *not a tool*.

01	**Concept**	Understanding the brief, the audience and the constraints, then pitching ideas worth animating
02	**Mood boards**	References, palettes and type directions to agree on a look before anything moves
03	**Styleframes**	Key frames designed to final quality, so everyone sees the film before it exists
04	**Storyboard**	Drawn by hand — the whole story, its pacing and its camera, frame by frame
05	**Animation**	2D, 3D, characters, typography or compositing, whatever the idea needs
06	**Sound & delivery**	To-the-beat editing, sound design, then every format and cut-down required

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Brands I've worked for

Riot Games / Team Vitality / Ubisoft / Esports World Cup / G2 Esports / Mastercard / Baccarat / Christofle / Laurent-Perrier / Clarins / Pierre Fabre / Pernod Ricard / International Chamber of Commerce / Visa / La Poste / Paris Saint-Germain / Roxy / ASUS ROG / BLAST.tv / Lafayette Anticipations / CEA / Krod Records

Alongside agencies like

Carré Noir / TBWA\Else / Havas / Prototype Studio / Helmut / Mazarine / Sixtine / Fisheye / Norma / Hypercontent

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A few numbers

2M

views across social media for LEC — Dance With Me

570K

YouTube views for the Esports World Cup 2024 explainer

299K+

YouTube views for LEC — Give Me Chaos!

100K+

views for each League of Legends explainer

4

continents for Baccarat Alchemy, a travelling 360° installation

23

years in graphic design and motion, since Gobelins 2003

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I do

Motion graphics
Graphic design
Illustration

I also do

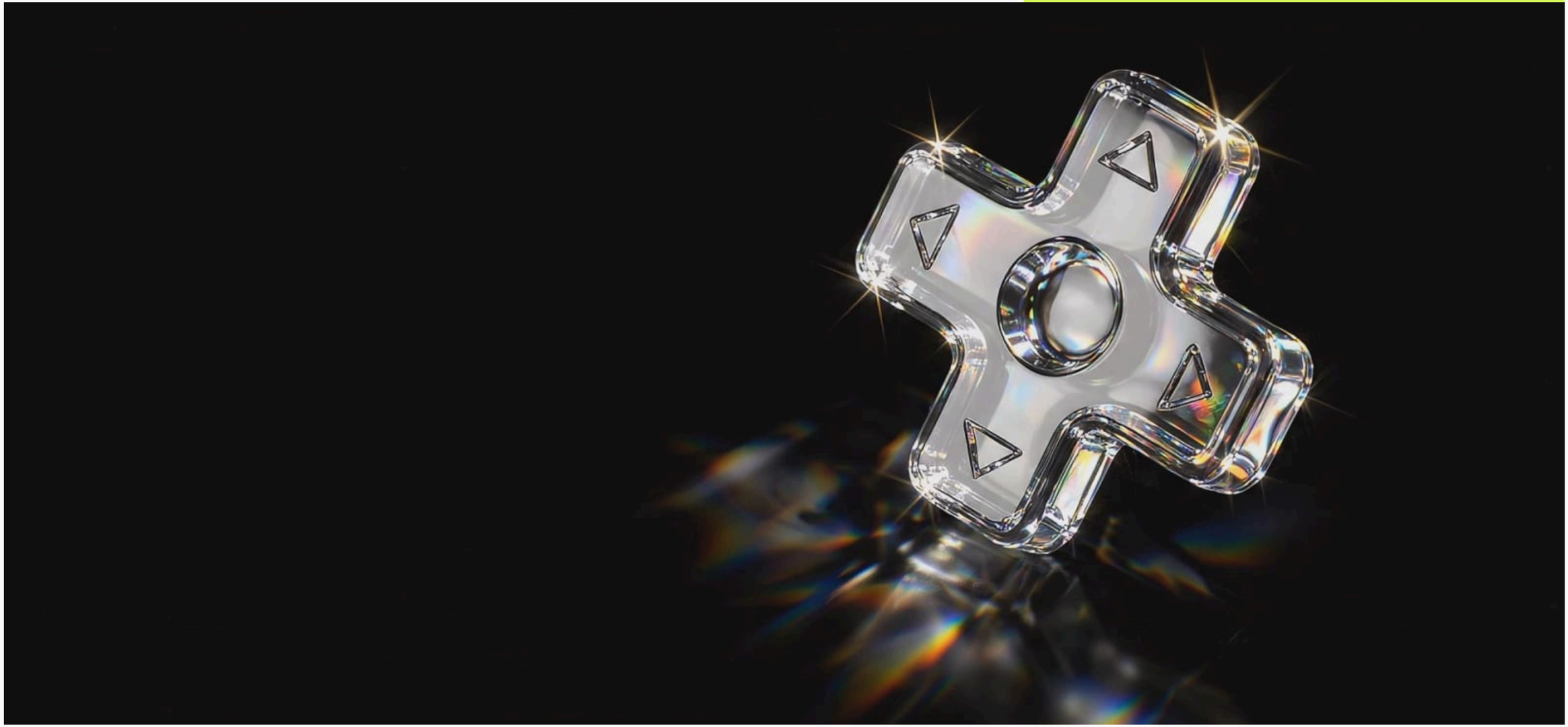
Editing
Photography
Sound design

Which means

Art direction / Concept development / Mood boards / Full 2D & 3D motion design / Character animation / Styleframes / Storyboarding / Title sequences / Poster design / UI design / Social content / Portrait photography / “To the beat” editing / Compositing / Music video treatment / Tech advising for animation or live action / Copywriting

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Watch the showreel — sound on, pleaaaaase



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01

Esports & Gaming

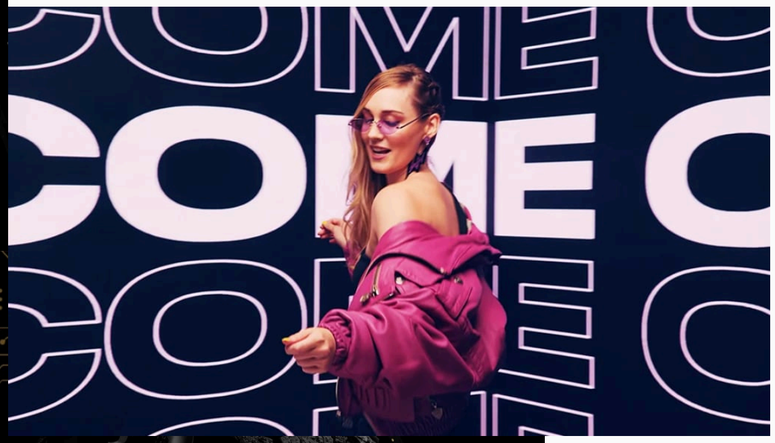
Seven years of broadcast packages, explainers, ads and social content for teams, publishers and tournament organizers — bold, energetic, and always on the pace of the scene.

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LEAGUE OF LEGENDS EMEA CHAMPIONSHIP


NRG


MASTERCARD
GAMER ACADEMY




CHAOS


1500
PLAYERS

Case study 01

Team Vitality
V.Hive 2.0

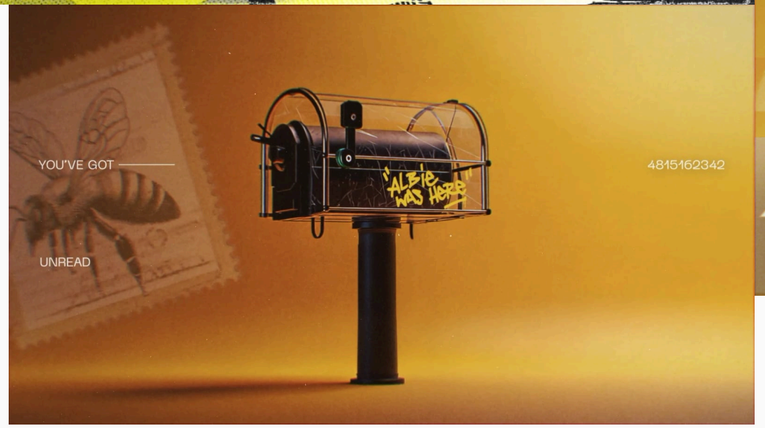
Team Vitality commissioned a video ad for the launch of the new V.Hive app version.

We landed on a Fallout / Loki-inspired visual direction — a really exciting brief to work on, combining multiple techniques.

Client	**Team Vitality**
Role	**Art Direction, Design, Animation**
Year	**2024**
Released on	**Streaming Platforms & Social**

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Case study 02

Vitality × ASUS RoG BLAST.tv

A 40-second advertisement for a collaboration between French esports leaders Team Vitality, hardware company ASUS ROG and streaming platform BLAST.tv.

The work covered the full creative process: storyboarding and technical guidance for the shoot, adapting client-provided 3D assets, proposing the music and developing the sound design.

Client	**Team Vitality**
Role	**Art Direction, Design, Animation, Technical Advisor**
Year	**2025**
Released on	**Streaming Platforms / Arena Screens**

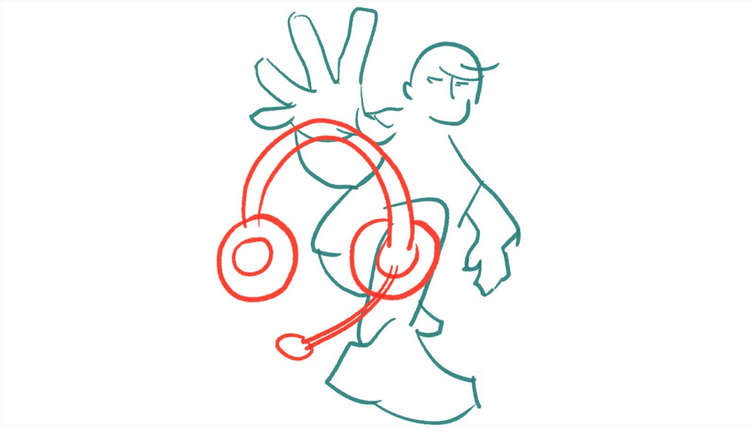
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KATOWICE 2025
VICTORY
WIN
LISBON


PRODUCT NAME






WINNERS
CHAMPIONS
VICTORIOUS
HISTORY MAKERS


WINNERS
LEGENDS
KICK


PERFECT AIM:
UNLOCKED


ACE
KICK


CONQUER


2025
DALLAS

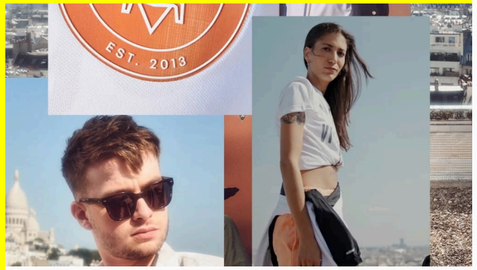

FULL FOCUS:
KICK

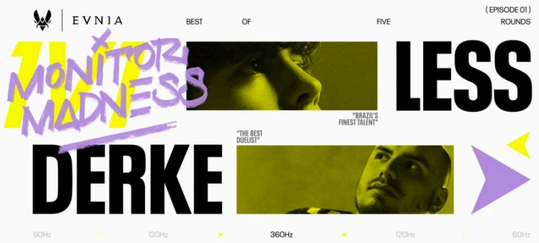

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EST. 2013


EVNIA
BEST OF FIVE
(EPISODE 01)
ROUNDS
MONITOR
MADNESS
LESS
DERKE
360Hz


COMING TO
JUST DANCE
UNLIMITED
HEY!
TO ENJOY ALL THESE EXCLUSIVE SONGS!
START THE YEAR

02

Luxury & Beverage

Title cards, greetings and product films for heritage houses, where motion has to be as precise and elegant as the craft it shows.

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Case study 03

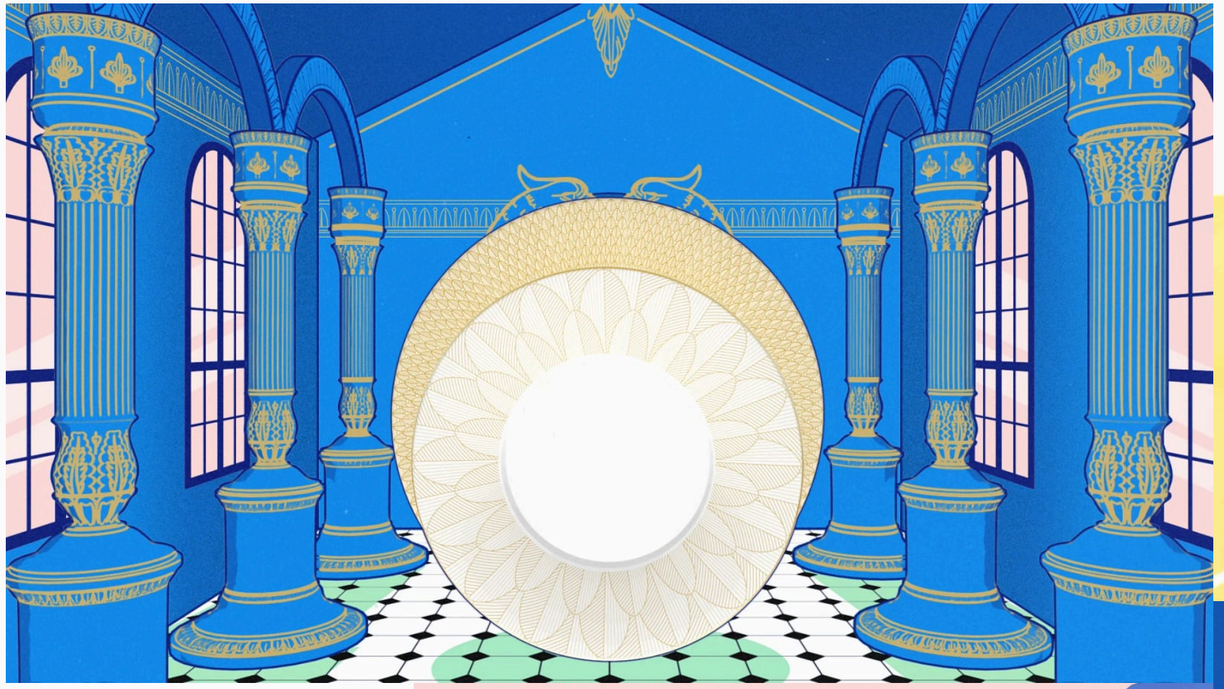
Christofle Malmaison

Partnering with French illustrator Laure Dorin, I created this 1-minute animation for the French luxury silversmith Christofle, built entirely around her illustrated artwork.

My role covered most of the motion design process — translating illustrations into fluid animation and pacing the narrative to match the elegance and craftsmanship at the heart of the brand.

Client	**Christofle**
Role	**Animation**
Year	**2026**
Agency	**Prototype Studio**
Released on	**Streaming platforms / Client website**

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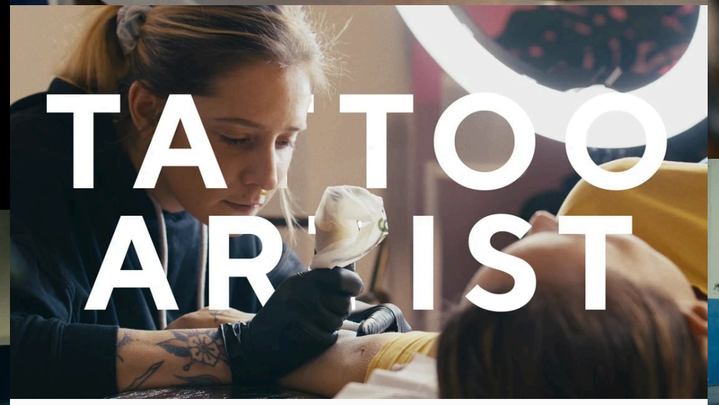


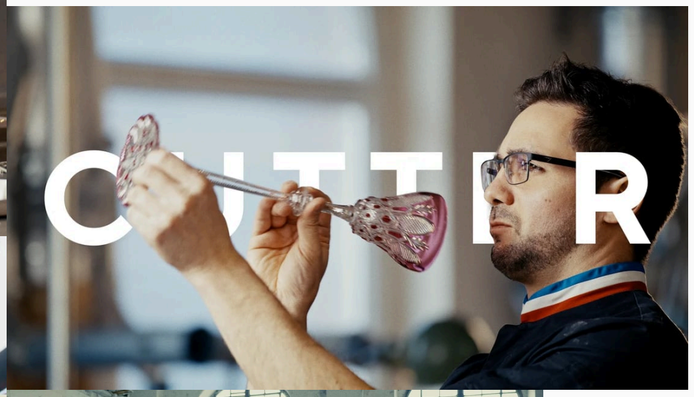


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Baccarat
RESONANCE


STARRED
CHEF


TATTOO
ARTIST


CUTTER


Baccarat
RESONANCE

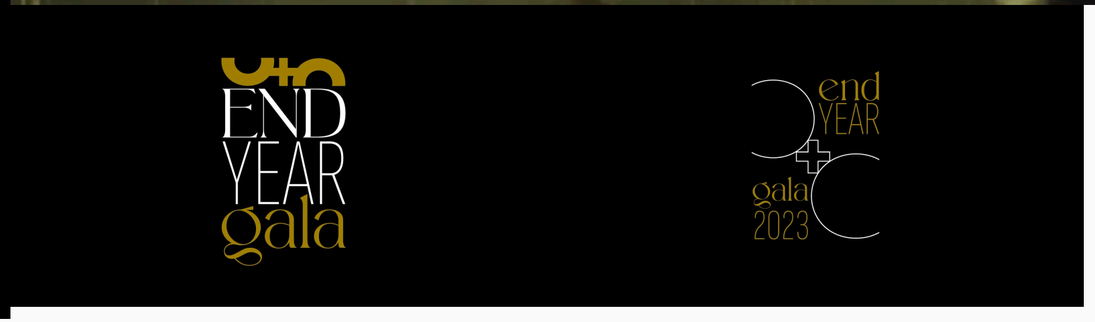

DANCER






O+O END
year GALA

O+O
endyear
GALA
2023


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gala

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2023

03

Music & Culture

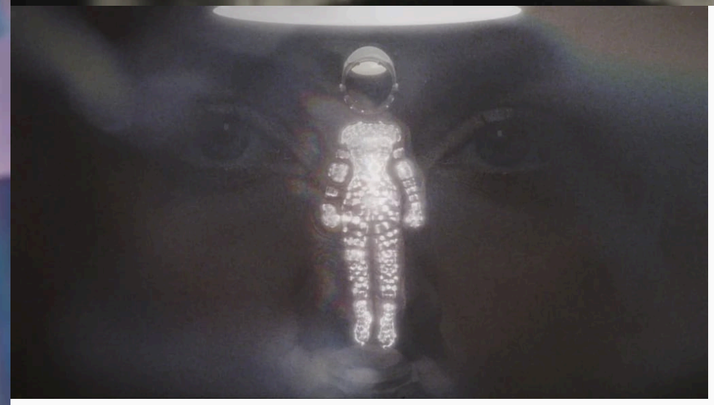
Complete music videos, from blank page to delivery, plus covers and title sequences — the projects where I get to tell my own stories.

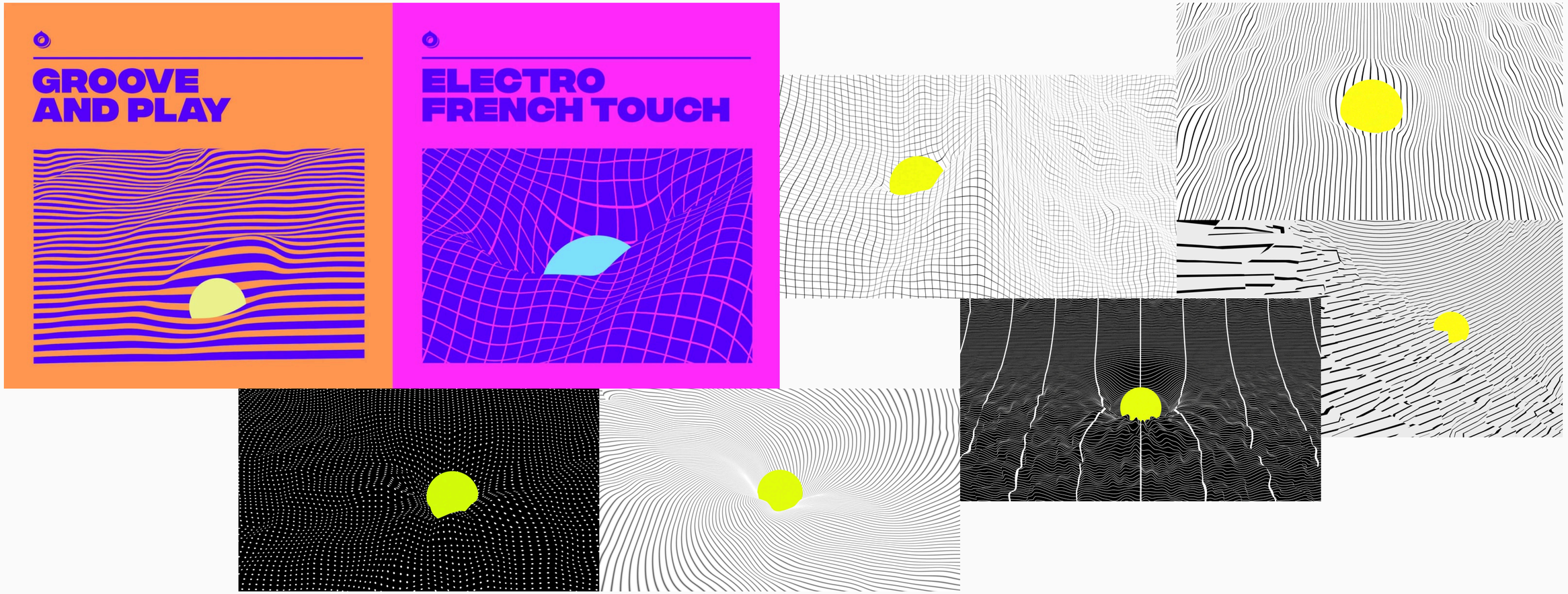
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GROOVE
AND PLAY
ELECTRO
FRENCH TOUCH

04

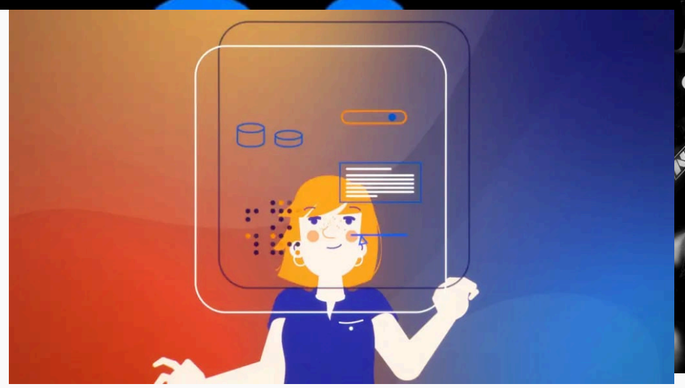
Institutions & Explainers

Motion identities and explainer films that make complex things clear — from the International Chamber of Commerce to tsunami risk awareness.

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to help
smaller businesses
thrive






NRG
WORLD'S TOP
ESPORTS CLUBS

05

Illustration & Characters

Apart from motion design, I also illustrate — which means I draw my own storyboards, and design most of the characters I animate.

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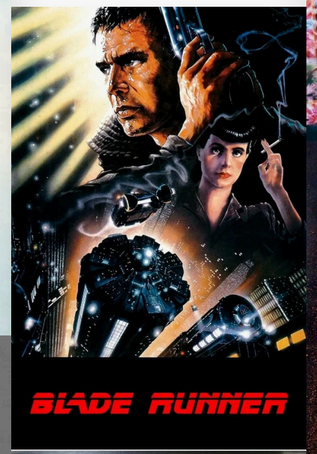


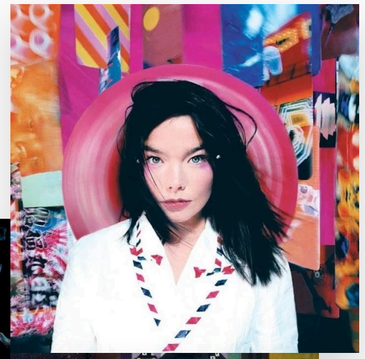


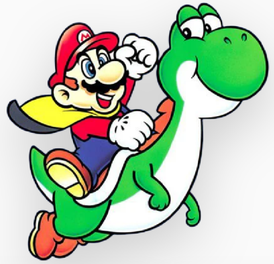

cute




AKIRA
アキラ


BLADE RUNNER

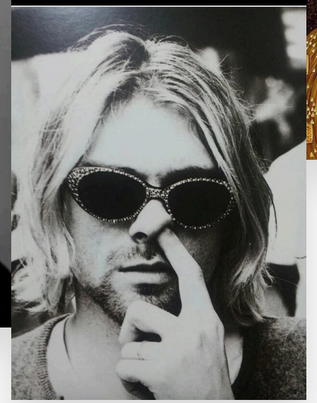







ROCKSTAR GAMES PRESENTS
RED DEAD REDEMPTION II








STANLEY KUBRICK'S
2001:
a space odyssey


SPIRITED AWAY





Good to know

Team or solo?

I can work with your team, or put together my own — people I personally know and trust, covering the whole scope of creative design.

What's your style?

I enjoy being eclectic, from minimalistic designs to heavily chaotic graphic arrangements. You could call me a chameleon.

Only motion?

Not at all! I'm just as into still graphic design, illustration and logo creation.

Budget?

I'm more of a "what's your project's budget?" kind of guy, but I do have a day rate — feel free to ask.

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Thanks for scrolling through

So, what are we *making next*?

New projects, questions or just a hello.
Based in the Pays Basque, France — working with brands and agencies worldwide.

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nicorako.com

Showreel →